Baptism

Purpose: *To show the ritual/ceremony of Baptism is a symbol of the turning away from sin and a turning to the Lord.*

Centred on: *Baptism by immersion.*

Acts 22: 3-16… Baptism is a divinely appointed ordinance (see Matt. 3:15; Mark 16:15, 16; John 3:3, 5; Titus 3:5). Nevertheless, in and of itself it does not avail to "wash away" sin. Belief, repentance, and the reception of the Holy Spirit must accompany the outward act in order to make it efficacious (see Matt. 28:19; Acts 2:38; 3:19; 8:36, 37). It was the death of Christ that made possible the removal of the guilt of sin (2 Cor. 5:20, 21; 1 Peter 2:24; 3:21; 1 John 1:7, 9).

Matthew 3: 1-17… Repent: Gr. metanoeō, literally, "to think differently after," hence, "to change one's mind," "to change one's purpose." It includes far more than confession of sin, though in the preaching of John that was, of course, included (v. 6). Theologically the word includes not only a change of mind but a new direction of the will, an altered purpose and attitude.

John 4: 1, 2… By personally accepting baptism at the hands of John, Jesus had approved the rite, declaring, *"Permit it to be so now, for thus is fitting for us to fulfil or righteousness"* (Matt. 3:15). Furthermore, Jesus' disciples performed the rite under His direction (John 3:22; 4:1). We are not told why Jesus Himself did not baptize. It may have been His purpose to avoid creating in the minds of any the idea that they possessed superior authority in the church because they had been baptized by Christ personally.

Matthew 28: 19… So far we have seen that Jesus himself was baptized, Jesus endorsed the ministry of his disciples baptizing and finally after his resurrection we find Jesus commanded his disciples to baptize.

John 3: 1-8… Nicodemus was a man of wealth, a Pharisee, and a member of the national council, the Sanhedrin. **Notice he came by night.** Aware of the attitude of the leaders generally toward Jesus, Nicodemus considered it wise not to compromise his reputation or position by letting it be known that he took Jesus seriously enough to seek a personal interview with Him. Nicodemus was himself a "teacher of Israel" (ch. 3:10), yet was willing to accept Jesus—who had no formal education and no official permission to teach—as his equal. The only explanation of this visit is that he sensed in his own heart the fact that Jesus was more than simply a teacher.

In verse 3, Jesus disregarded the compliment and directed His reply to the unspoken appeal for truth implicit in the fact that Nicodemus had sought Him out for a private interview. Jesus had essentially responded to the question of how one must be saved. He mentions two things:

- Water.
- Spirit.

Note: Baptize: Gr. baptizō, "to dip," "to immerse." John the evangelist emphasizes the fact that John the Baptist "was baptizing in Aenon near to Salim, because there was much water there" (John 3:23). Furthermore, all four Gospel writers note that most, if not all, of John's ministry was carried on in the immediate vicinity of the Jordan River (Matt. 3:6; Mark 1:5, 9; Luke 3:3; John 1:28). Had John not baptized by immersion he would have found sufficient water almost anywhere in Palestine.

Being born of the water is an outward symbol of the inward reality of having died to the world and living the spirit filled life.

Romans 6: 3, 4…A strong emphasis on the meaning of baptism as relating to a type of death. The meaning of this is given in the verses that follow, especially in vs. 10 and 11, where Paul explains that as Christ died to sin, so the Christian should regard himself as dead to sin. And if by baptism the believer has shown his participation in Christ's death unto sin (v. 10) in his behalf, then surely he cannot continue living in the sin that made that death necessary (v. 2).

In order for the sacrifice of Christ to accomplish salvation for the sinner, the individual believer must knowingly participate in the meaning and in the experience represented by the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ for his sake. As a public confession of this experience the believer submits to the ceremony of immersion in harmony with the command of Jesus (Matt. 28:19).

Acts 8: 26-39… Ethiopian Eunuch- Philip and the Eunuch went INTO the water…sprinkling does not symbolize death. This Ethiopian was a gentile and a eunuch and would have been looked down on in the Jewish sight, but this shows that baptism is available for everyone regardless of past or circumstances.

1 Corinthians 12: 13, 14…The teaching of scripture is that we are all baptized into one body.

Ephesians 5: 23…The body of Christ is his church.

Acts 16: 25-34…As soon as conviction came to the jailer he gave evidence of a change of heart. The hardened pagan official became a sympathetic Christian, solicitous for the welfare of the suffering evangelists. He had no authority to release the prisoners, but he did what he could to ease

their pains by washing their lacerated backs. Such tender ministry was practical proof of his conversion.

It is clear that the instruction given by Paul and Silas was comprehensive. It was wholeheartedly received by the jailer's household, and led them to desire and to receive baptism. He, who had just washed the wounds of his prisoners, was now, with those who were dear to him, washed from the stains of sin. This reciprocal ministry is typical of genuine Christian fellowship. It is not unreasonable to suppose that the prison contained a pool or cistern where baptism by immersion could take place.

Ephesians 4: 4-6…There is one baptism, Baptism by immersion.

CONCLUSION

Baptism is a **marriage** to Christ and we want people to know what this involves…

Who is this, What do they expect of me, What am I getting into

TEACH – BAPTISE – TEACH

Being Baptised into Jesus is the same as the Church

Is there evidence of change in your life, is God the most important thing in your life.

Baptism is a sign of repentance…Luke 3:7-8

Matt 28:19-20…**HEAD**- Baptism was not divorced from discipleship- followers were to work in the ways Jesus worked. Jesus says that there must be an understanding of what baptism involved

James 2:19… **HANDS**- we need to be reaching out to Jesus, believe and intellectual assent is not enough we have to be reaching out in faith to Jesus.

Acts 2:38…**HEART**- preparation for baptism must involve a sorrow for sin and a turning away from it.

APPEAL

Acts 8:36

YOU HAVE FOLLOWING JESUS AND HAVE PUT YOUR FAITH IN JESUS AND TURNED AWAY FROM YOUR SINS, IS THERE ANYTHING KEEPING YOU BACK FROM BEING BAPTISED?

DEFEND IT

1 Cor 15:29

BAPTISM FOR THE DEAD.

Paul is arguing with some people who are against the resurrection. He uses the example of those who practice the baptism on behalf of the dead simply to show that these people even believe in a resurrection… or else they would not do this if they did not believe there would be a resurrection.